

Pride and Prejudice

Chapter I

Landscape edition · 15 graphite panels · 856 source words

Performance appears inside the displayed words. Bold, spacing, stretched letters, pauses, and tempo marks guide delivery. The unchanged source and reversible span map accompany this edition. The opening 'I t' remains an extraction defect.

A fortune and a wife



GENERATED GRAPHITE INTERPRETATION

NARRATOR

I t is a truth universally acknowledged, / that a single man in possession of a good fortune, must be in want of a wife. // However little known the feelings or views of such a man may be on his first entering a neighbourhood, / this truth is so well fixed in the minds of the surrounding families, that he is considered the rightful property of some one or other of their daughters.

//

Netherfield is let



GENERATED GRAPHITE INTERPRETATION

MRS BENNET

«My de-e-ear Mr. Bennet»,

NARRATOR

said his lady to him one day,

MRS BENNET

«have you heard that Netherfield Park is let at LAAST?»

NARRATOR

Mr. Bennet replied that he had not.

MRS BENNET

«But it IS»,

NARRATOR

returned she;

MRS BENNET

«for Mrs. Long has just been here, / and she told me all about it».

NARRATOR

Mr. Bennet made no answer.

///

An invitation to speak



GENERATED GRAPHITE INTERPRETATION

MRS BENNET

«Do you not want to know who has taken it?»

NARRATOR

cried his wife impatiently.

MR BENNET

«YOU want to tell me, / and I have no objection to hearing it».

NARRATOR

This was invitation enough.

//

The arrival



GENERATED GRAPHITE INTERPRETATION

MRS BENNET

«Why, my dear, you must know, Mrs. Long says that Netherfield is taken by a young man of large fortune from the north of England; // > that he came down on Monday in a chaise and four to see the place, / and was so much delighted with it, that he agreed with Mr. Morris immediately; // that he is to take possession before Michaelmas, and some of his servants are to be in the house by the end of next week».

//

Four thousand a year



GENERATED GRAPHITE INTERPRETATION

MR BENNET

«What is his name?»

MRS BENNET

«Bingley».

MR BENNET

«Is he married or single?»

MRS BENNET

«Oh! SI-nгле, my dear, to be sure! // A single man of large fortune; / four... or five THOUSAND a year. // What a fine thing for our girls!»

//

The marriage plan



GENERATED GRAPHITE INTERPRETATION

MR BENNET

«How so? / How can it affect them?»

MRS BENNET

«My dear Mr. Be-e-ennet»,

NARRATOR

replied his wife,

MRS BENNET

«how can you be so TIRE-some! // You must know that I am thinking of his marrying one of them».

//

The required visit



GENERATED GRAPHITE INTERPRETATION

MR BENNET

«Is that his design in settling here?»

MRS BENNET

«DESIGN! nonsense, how can you talk so! // > But it is very likely that he may fall in love with one of them, / and therefore you MUST visit him as soon as he comes».

//

A compliment with teeth



GENERATED GRAPHITE INTERPRETATION

MR BENNET

«I see no occasion for that. // You and the girls may go, or you may send them by themselves, / which perhaps will be still better, for as you are as handsome as any of them, / Mr. Bingley may like you the best of the party».

//

Five daughters



GENERATED GRAPHITE INTERPRETATION

MRS BENNET

«My dear, you flatter me. // I certainly have had my share of beauty, but I do not pretend to be any thing extraordinary now. // When a woman has five grown up daughters, / she ought to give over thinking of her own beauty».

MR BENNET

«In such cases, a woman has not often much beauty to think of».

//

The rules of visiting



GENERATED GRAPHITE INTERPRETATION

MRS BENNET

«But, my dear, you MUST indeed GO and see Mr. Bingley when he comes into the neighbourhood».

MR BENNET

«It is more than I engage for, / I assure you».

MRS BENNET

«But consider your daughters. // Only think what an establishment it would be for one of them. // Sir William and Lady Lucas are determined to go, / merely on that account, for in general you know they visit no new comers. // > Indeed you must go, for it will be im-POSS-ible for us to visit him if you do not».

//

A word for Lizzy



MR BENNET

«You are over scrupulous, surely. // I dare say Mr. Bingley will be very glad to see you; / and I will send a few lines by you to assure him of my hearty consent to his marrying which ever he chuses of the girls; // though I must throw in a good word for my little Lizzy».

//

GENERATED GRAPHITE INTERPRETATION

The favourite daughter



GENERATED GRAPHITE INTERPRETATION

MRS BENNET

«I desire you will do NO such thing. // Lizzy is not a bit better than the others; / and I am sure she is not half so handsome as Jane, nor half so good humoured as Lydia. // But you are AL-ways giving her the preference».

MR BENNET

«They have none of them much to recommend them»,

NARRATOR

replied he;

MR BENNET

«they are all silly and ignorant like other girls; // but Lizzy has something more of quickness than her sisters».

//

My poor nerves



MRS BENNET

«Mr. Bennet, how can you abuse your own children in such a way? // You take delight in vexing me. // You have no compassion for my poor ner-r-ves».

///

GENERATED GRAPHITE INTERPRETATION

Twenty years of nerves



GENERATED GRAPHITE INTERPRETATION

MR BENNET

«You mistake me, my dear. // I have a HIGH respect for your nerves. // They are my old... friends. / I have heard you mention them with consideration these last twenty years at least».

MRS BENNET

«Ah, / you do not know what I SUF-fer...».

//

The business of her life



GENERATED GRAPHITE INTERPRETATION

MR BENNET

«But I hope you will get over it, / and live to see many young men of four thousand a year come into the neighbourhood».

MRS BENNET

«It will be no use to us, if twenty such should come, / since you WILL not visit them».

MR BENNET

«Depend upon it, my dear, / that when there are TWEN-ty, / I will visit them all».

NARRATOR

Mr. Bennet was so odd a mixture of quick parts, sarcastic humour, reserve, and caprice, / that the experience of three and twenty years had been insufficient to make his wife understand his character. // Her mind was less difficult to develope. // She was a woman of mean understanding, little information, and uncertain temper. // When she was discontented she fancied herself nervous. // The business of her life was to get her daughters married; / its solace was visiting and news.

//

Words and expressions · 1/3

acknowledged · ak-NOL-ijd

accepted as true

The class acknowledged her point.

possession · puh-ZESH-uhn

ownership or control

The key remained in his possession.

neighbourhood · NAY-buh-huud

the local area

A new family entered the neighbourhood.

rightful · RYTE-fuhl

legally or morally deserved

She reclaimed her rightful place.

let · LET

rented to someone

The house was let yesterday.

chaise and four · SHAYZ and FOUR

a carriage drawn by four horses

They arrived in a chaise and four.

Michaelmas · MIK-uhl-muhs

the feast day on 29 September

The tenant arrives before Michaelmas.

tiresome · TYE-uh-suhm

annoying or wearying

The repeated delay became tiresome.

Words and expressions · 2/3

design · dih-ZYNE

a plan or intention

Marriage was never his design.

establishment · ih-STAB-lish-muhnt

a secure household or marriage

The match promised an establishment.

scrupulous · SKROO-pyuh-luhs

very careful about propriety

He was scrupulous about introductions.

hearty consent · HAR-tee kuhn-SENT

warm or full approval

Her parents gave hearty consent.

preference · PREF-uh-ruhns

greater liking for one choice

He showed a preference for Lizzy.

quickness · KWIK-nuhs

mental speed and wit

Her quickness shaped the reply.

vexing · VEK-sing

annoying or troubling

The joke kept vexing him.

Words and expressions · 3/3

compassion · kuhm-PASH-uhn
concern for another's suffering
She answered with compassion.

sarcastic · sar-KAS-tik
using cutting irony
His sarcastic answer hid affection.

reserve · rih-ZURV
restraint in showing feelings
Her reserve made motives unclear.

caprice · kuh-PREES
a sudden changeable impulse
The choice seemed driven by caprice.

develope · dih-VEL-uhp
older spelling of develop
Experience helped her develop patience.

mean understanding · MEEN un-duh-STAN-ding
limited intelligence in this older sense
The phrase describes limited judgment.

solace · SOL-iss
comfort during distress
Books became her solace.
